MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
FIRST SEMESTER MGU- UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION NOVEMBER 2024
First Semester
Core Course- MG1CCRBBA103– Business Communication-I
(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

QP CODE:24900019

Part A
Short Essay Type Questions
Answer 2 Questions
Each question carries 5 marks

Instruction to Examiners

For application-level questions, answers should be focused on identifying and explaining key concepts. Marks will be awarded based on the student's ability to correctly identify the relevant concept, provide a clear explanation of how it applies to the scenario, and include an appropriate example or practical relevance. The emphasis is on clarity, correctness, and relevance rather than length, encouraging students to apply concepts effectively in real-world contexts.

Marks will be awarded based on the points discussed in class and the notes provided by the instructor. However, the answer scheme and the process of assigning marks must be strictly followed. The evaluation will focus on the correct identification and explanation of concepts as outlined in the marking scheme.

1. You are attending a company-wide meeting where the CEO presents the annual report and future goals for the organization. Later that day, you hear a colleague chatting with friends at lunch about their thoughts on the CEO's presentation. What types of communication are being used in this scenario? Identify which example represents formal communication and which represents informal communication. Explain why they are categorized as such.

a. Identification of Communication Types - 2 Marks

Clearly identifies **formal communication** (CEO's presentation in the meeting). *(1 Mark)*
Clearly identifies **informal communication** (colleague chatting with friends at lunch). *(1 Mark)*

b. Explanation of Formal Communication- 1.5 Marks

Explains formal communication as structured, professional, and involving official channels (e.g., the CEO presenting an annual report to the company).

c. Explanation of Informal Communication -1.5 Marks

Explains informal communication as casual, spontaneous, and typically occurring outside official channels (e.g., casual discussion at lunch about the CEO's presentation).

2. A communication breakdown may result from a supervisor attempting to have a conversation in a noisy factory where it is almost impossible to understand and hear one another. Comment and explain the barrier the supervisor is facing.

a. Identification of the Barrier - 1.5 Marks

Correctly identifies the barrier as physical noise or environmental barrier.

b. Explanation of the Barrier - 2 Marks

Provides a clear explanation of how physical noise (e.g., machinery sounds) in the factory prevents clear hearing and understanding during communication. *(1.5 Marks)*

Includes how this impacts the communication process, such as misinterpretation or failure to convey the intended message. *(0.5 Marks)*

c. Suggestions to Overcome the Barrier - 1.5 Marks

Suggests practical solutions like moving to a quieter location, using communication tools (e.g., microphones, headsets), or relying on written communication.

3. A new employee, Ann is communicating with colleagues through emails and chat apps. What essential etiquette should they follow to ensure professionalism in their digital communications with examples?

a. Identification of Key Etiquette - 2 Marks

Lists essential professional digital communication etiquette such as using a polite and respectful tone, being concise and clear in messages, proofreading for grammar and spelling errors, responding promptly and appropriately.

b. Explanation of Each Etiquette - 2 Marks

Explains the importance of each etiquette point with relevance to professionalism.

Using a respectful tone avoids misunderstandings in email or chat.

Clear and concise messages help save time and improve communication efficiency.

C. Practical Examples of Application -1 Mark

Provides specific examples of proper etiquette, such as:

Greeting colleagues with "Dear [Name]" in emails.
Using professional sign-offs like "Best regards" or "Sincerely."

4. What tools are most commonly used for communication in the gig economy, and how do they facilitate collaboration?

a. Explain gig economy tools uses -1 Mark

The gig economy relies on digital tools to bridge the gap between employers and independent contractors, enabling seamless communication and collaboration across diverse teams and geographies.

b. Identify and Explain the uses -4 marks

Messaging and Collaboration Platforms- Slack, Microsoft Teams, WhatsApp

Video Conferencing Tools- Zoom, Google Meet, Microsoft Teams

Project Management Tools, Document Collaboration Tools- Google Docs, Dropbox, SharePoint

Freelance and Gig Platforms, Social Media and Networking Platforms

Marks may be given if the student identifies any three of these tools.

5.Reliance Pharmaceuticals, a leading pharmaceutical company based in Mumbai, employs o ver 3,000 professionals, including researchers, sales teams, and administrative staff. The com pany operates nationwide and collaborates with international partners.
The company faced challenges in maintaining clear and effective written communication acro ss its various departments and with international collaborators. This led to misunderstandings, delayed project timelines, and decreased productivity.
To address these issues, Reliance Pharmaceuticals decided to enhance its channels of written communication. Critically evaluate the different channels of written communication that can be implemented by Reliance Pharmaceuticals and its advantages.

a. Introduction and Context -2 Marks

Clearly outlines the challenges faced by Reliance Pharmaceuticals related to written communication. *(1 Mark)*

Briefly explains the need for enhanced written communication channels in the context of the company's operations (e.g., multiple departments, international collaborations). *(1 Mark)*

b. Identification of Written Communication Channels - 3 Marks

Identifies relevant written communication channels such as:

Emails, Internal messaging platforms (e.g., Slack, Microsoft Teams), Collaborative tools (e.g., Google Docs, SharePoint), Formal reports and documentation, Newsletters and memos, Project management tools (e.g., Asana, Trello) *etc.*

c. Critical Evaluation of Channels - 4 Marks

Critically evaluates the advantages of each channel explained above with examples relevant to Reliance Pharmaceuticals:

- **Emails**: Suitable for professional and formal communication across departments and international partners.
- **Internal Messaging Platforms**: Enables quick communication within teams, reducing delays.

Marks may be given to any other written communication channels applicable in this context

d. Conclusion and Recommendations -1 Mark

Summarizes the importance of selecting appropriate communication channels for improving productivity and collaboration.

Provides recommendations tailored to Reliance Pharmaceuticals, such as training employees on new tools or integrating multiple channels into a unified system.

6. TO & CO is a startup company, which produces and sells homemade chocolates. Even though the product is good, they failed to market the product. The owner of the company decided to collaborate with some social media influencers to market their products. Whether this method of communication will help to reach the actual target customers and explain the importance of digital collaboration in this era.

a. Introduction and Context - 2 Marks

Describes the challenges faced by TO & CO in marketing their product effectively. *(1 Mark)*

Introduces the decision to collaborate with social media influencers as a marketing strategy. *(1 Mark)*

b. Evaluation of Social Media Influencer Marketing - 3 Marks

Explains how social media influencer marketing works and discusses its effectiveness in reaching specific target audiences

c. Importance of Digital Collaboration in This Era - 4 Marks

Discusses the relevance of digital collaboration in modern business, focusing on Wider audience reach, Cost-effective marketing compared to traditional methods, building customer trust and engagement through authentic communication, Ability to adapt to consumer preferences in real time.

Provide marks to any other importance applicable to digital collaboration

d. Conclusion and Recommendations -1 Mark

Summarizes the benefits of influencer collaboration and digital marketing for TO & CO.

Provides suggestions, such as selecting the right influencers, monitoring campaign effectiveness, and diversifying marketing channels.

7. TechX Innovations is a multinational company with employees working remotely from different countries. The company has adopted virtual communication tools to facilitate collaboration across time zones. Employees use a combination of synchronous (real-time) communication methods like video conferencing, and asynchronous (non-real-time) communication such as emails and project management platforms. Despite these tools, the company is facing challenges such as time zone conflicts, communication delays, and misunderstandings due to lack of non-verbal cues. Additionally, employees report feeling isolated and disconnected from the team.

1.Apply your understanding of synchronous, asynchronous, and blended communication methods to recommend a comprehensive virtual communication strategy for the company.

2. Identify and explain the potential challenges of virtual communication that TechX Innovations faces.

3. Propose practical solutions to address these challenges and improve both team collaboration and individual engagement.

a. Comprehensive virtual communication strategy for the company - 4 Marks

Understanding of Communication Methods (3 Marks) and Recommendation (1 Mark)

Clearly defines and *differentiates synchronous* (e.g., video conferencing, live chats) and *asynchronous* (e.g., emails, shared documents) communication methods. Explains *blended* communication methods that combine synchronous and asynchronous tools to balance flexibility and real-time interaction.

Recommends a *structured virtual communication* strategy tailored to TechX's challenges, such as Using asynchronous tools to reduce time zone conflicts and using blended tools like recorded meetings

b. Identification of Challenges - 3 Marks

Lists potential challenges, including Time zone conflicts, Delays in responses for asynchronous communication, Lack of non-verbal cues leading to misunderstandings. Explains how these challenges impact team collaboration, productivity, and employee well-being

c. Practical Solutions to Address Challenges- 3 Marks

Solutions for Improving Collaboration like Using time zone management tools or scheduling platforms, creating a shared knowledge base, Encouraging the use of visual aids, such as screen sharing and diagrams, during virtual meetings, Providing training for effective virtual communication and cultural sensitivity etc.,

8. Alex is a high school student who frequently uses social media and online forums. He values respectful online interactions but faces negative behaviour on social media and forums. Review the strategies he can implement to practice good digital citizenship in response to such challenges. Explore the potential benefits of being a responsible digital citizen, along with the obstacles he might encounter in fostering a positive online environment.

a. Strategies for Practicing Good Digital Citizenship - 4 Marks

Understanding Digital Citizenship - Defines digital citizenship as responsible, respectful, and ethical behavior in the online world (2 Marks)

Strategies to Respond to Negative Behavior - Ignoring or blocking users who display negative behavior, reporting harmful content to platform moderators, practicing respectful communication even when provoked, verifying and sharing credible information to combat misinformation, engaging in positive and constructive conversations, advocating for kindness and empathy online. (2 Marks)

b. Benefits of Being a Responsible Digital Citizen - 5 Marks

- ✓ Online Safety and Security
- ✓ Respecting Others' Rights
- ✓ Promoting Accurate Information
- ✓ Avoiding Cyberbullying and Harassment
- ✓ Maintaining Digital Health and Wellness
- ✓ Practicing Inclusivity
- ✓ Reporting Misconduct

c. Obstacles in fostering a positive online environment - 1 Mark

- ✓ Prevalence of anonymity, making accountability difficult.
- ✓ Resistance from individuals who perpetuate negative behavior.
- ✓ Lack of platform enforcement on community guidelines

Provide marks to any other obstacles applicable to digital citizenship.

Part C
Letter Writing
Compulsory Question

Each question is worth 20 marks: 10 marks for the record submission and 10 marks for the drafted letter.

10 marks for record submission and 10 marks for written letter

1. Structure and Formatting - 2 Marks (1 mark each)
   Includes all key sections: header, subject, salutation, introduction, body paragraphs, and closing.
   Properly formatted with professional tone and alignment.
2. Introduction - 2 Marks
   Clearly mentions the purpose of the letter and the internship being applied for.
   Highlights educational background briefly.
3. Body Paragraphs - 4 Marks- (1 mark each)
   Educational Background and Skills -
      Describes academic qualifications and relevant skills.
      Includes specific examples (e.g., projects, coursework) demonstrating abilities.
   Career Aspiration and Alignment -
      Clearly states career goals.
4. Conclusion -2 Marks
   Expresses gratitude and interest in the opportunity.
   Provides contact information and a call to action (e.g., follow-up for an interview).

Prepared By,

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